Ahmad Zaki

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Education

York University Sep 2022 - Dec 2026
Honours Bachelor of Science in Computer Science *Toronto, ON*
Courses: Data Structures, Database Systems, Big Data Systems, Operating System Fundamentals, Building E-Commerce Systems, Object-Oriented Programming

Experience

Technical System Analyst Sep 2025 – Dec 2025
Royal Bank of Canada *Toronto, ON*

- Triaged and resolved **100+ cloud support tickets** over 70 days across **Azure, AWS, and Databricks**, maintaining SLAs and reducing average resolution time for the cloud application support team
- Diagnosed edge-case failures in shared **Terraform/IaC pipelines** used to deploy cloud resources, documenting root causes and workarounds that unblocked **20+ engineers** across multiple teams
- Managed user access requests, account onboarding/offboarding, and critical cloud service provider updates, collaborating with **Cloud Operations, SRE, and Engineering** teams to maintain platform stability
- Authored and updated team **playbooks** based on resolved incidents, creating reusable runbooks that improved first-contact resolution rates for recurring infrastructure issues

Software Engineering Fellow Jun 2024 – Sep 2024
Headstarter AI *Remote*

- Built and deployed **5 AI projects in 5 weeks** using **React, Next.js, Firebase, Clerk, and Vercel**, following agile methodologies with weekly sprints and CI/CD practices for iterative deployment
- Worked in a team of 3 to develop an interactive customer support agent using **Next.js**, integrating a custom **RAG pipeline** with OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, and Pinecone that responds based on a company's knowledge base
- Collaborated with 3 Fellows to build and deploy a **SaaS flashcard generator** using the **OpenAI GPT-4o mini API**, integrated a paywall and custom pricing plans via the **Stripe API**
- Participated in weekly sessions with engineers from Google, Y Combinator, Stanford, Amazon, and venture-backed startups

Projects

Payment Request API | *Java, Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, JWT, JUnit 5, Docker*

- Built a **RESTful Spring Boot API** simulating a peer-to-peer payment request system, implementing full request lifecycle management across **PENDING, ACCEPTED, DECLINED, and EXPIRED** states
- Implemented **JWT-based authentication** with Spring Security, securing all endpoints via a stateless filter chain with role-based access control
- Designed a **transactional fund transfer** flow using **@Transactional** to guarantee atomic balance updates on payment acceptance, preventing partial writes under concurrent requests
- Automated **payment request expiry** using **@Scheduled** jobs and generated live API documentation with **Springdoc OpenAPI**, reducing manual documentation overhead

AI Content Generator SaaS | *React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, PostgreSQL, Stripe, OpenAI API*

- Built a **full-stack SaaS platform** with a React/Tailwind frontend and TypeScript backend, integrating **OpenAI APIs and generative AI services** to generate images, audio, code snippets, and conversations on demand
- Implemented end-to-end user authentication via **Clerk**, payment processing and subscription management via **Stripe**, and usage tracking with **Prisma ORM** on a PostgreSQL database
- Built an API integration layer using **Axios** to coordinate requests across AI provider, including retry logic, error handling, and rate limiting.

Media Storage Hub | *Angular, TypeScript, AWS (S3, Lambda, DynamoDB), Amplify*

- Developed a **cloud-native** media management web app on AWS, using **S3** for file storage, **Lambda** for serverless processing, and **DynamoDB** for metadata tracking with unique identification tags
- Integrated **AWS Amplify** for user authentication and leveraged Amplify CLI to set up **CI/CD pipelines**, enabling automated deployment on each push
- Built a responsive Angular UI with **lazy loading** and **NgRx** state management, reducing initial load time and providing a seamless UX across device sizes

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, PostgreSQL, HTML, CSS
Frameworks: React, Next.js, Angular, Node.js, Tailwind CSS
Cloud & Tools: Azure, AWS (S3, Lambda, DynamoDB, Amplify), Terraform, Databricks, Git, Linux, Jenkins